

2 Eve

The first woman and "the mother of all living," who was deceived and yet received the first promise of hope.

Eve is the first woman in Scripture, made by God from Adam's side to be his partner. Her story holds both the goodness of creation and the tragedy of the fall. She listened to the serpent, doubted God's word, and ate the forbidden fruit. She then shared it with her husband. Yet Eve is also the woman whose "seed" God promised would bruise the serpent's head. She became a mother, grieved a murdered son, and still named her third son as a sign of God's faithfulness. Her life shows how temptation works, how sin spreads through a family, and how God's promise keeps going anyway.

At a glance

Name	Hebrew <i>Chavvah</i> , linked with "living" (Genesis 3:20). Adam first calls her "Woman" (Genesis 2:23)
Family	Husband Adam; sons Cain, Abel and Seth, plus other sons and daughters (Genesis 4:1–2, 25; 5:4)
When	At the beginning. Scripture gives no calendar date (see the note on the next page)
Key places	The garden of Eden; the land outside Eden
Key people	Adam, the serpent, Cain, Abel, Seth
Death	Not recorded
Main passages	Genesis 2:18–4:2; 4:25
New Testament	2 Corinthians 11:3; 1 Timothy 2:13–14

"And Adam called his wife's name Eve; because she was the mother of all living."

Genesis 3:20, KJV

The life of Eve

Genesis gives no calendar dates or ages for Eve. The order below follows the text. As with Adam, Christians differ on whether Genesis 1–3 is best read as literal history or as history told in a more literary way.

Day six	● Made in God's image God creates humankind "male and female" in his image and blesses them together. <i>Genesis 1:27–28</i>
In Eden	● Made from Adam's side It is not good for the man to be alone. God makes the woman from Adam's rib, and Adam receives her with joy. <i>Genesis 2:18–25</i>
In Eden	● Tempted The serpent asks, "Yea, hath God said...?" Eve adds to God's command ("neither shall ye touch it"). The serpent then denies that she will die. <i>Genesis 3:1–5</i>
In Eden	● Eats and gives She sees that the tree is good for food, pleasant to the eyes and desirable to make one wise. She eats and gives to her husband with her. <i>Genesis 3:6–7</i>
In Eden	● Judged and named Eve says, "The serpent beguiled me, and I did eat." God promises enmity between the serpent and her seed, and pain in childbearing. Adam names her Eve. <i>Genesis 3:13–20</i>
After Eden	● Clothed and sent out God makes coats of skins for Adam and his wife and sends them out of the garden. <i>Genesis 3:21–24</i>
After Eden	● Mother of Cain and Abel She bears Cain, saying, "I have gotten a man from the LORD," and then Abel. Later Cain kills Abel. <i>Genesis 4:1–8</i>
After Eden	● Mother of Seth She bears Seth, saying God has appointed "another seed instead of Abel, whom Cain slew." <i>Genesis 4:25</i>

Key activities

Genesis does not name the serpent as Satan. The New Testament makes that link (Revelation 12:9; 20:2).

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- I Shared God's image and blessing.** She was made in God's image and received the command to fill and rule the earth with Adam. *Genesis 1:27-28*

 - 2 Became Adam's partner.** God made her as "an help meet for him," a helper fit for him, and brought her to the man. *Genesis 2:18, 21-22*

 - 3 Listened to the serpent.** She entered a conversation that questioned God's goodness and his word. *Genesis 3:1-3*

 - 4 Misquoted God's command.** She added "neither shall ye touch it," words God had not said to Adam in Genesis 2. *Genesis 2:17; 3:3*

 - 5 Ate the forbidden fruit.** Drawn by what looked good, pleasant and wise, she took and ate. *Genesis 3:6*

 - 6 Gave to her husband.** She passed the fruit to Adam, who was with her. *Genesis 3:6*

 - 7 Hid from God.** With Adam she sewed fig leaves and hid among the trees. *Genesis 3:7-8*

 - 8 Told what happened.** When God questioned her, she answered, "The serpent beguiled me, and I did eat." *Genesis 3:13*

 - 9 Heard the first promise.** God said her seed would bruise the serpent's head. Many Christians read this as the first promise of the gospel. *Genesis 3:15*

 - 10 Received her name.** Adam named her Eve, "the mother of all living," even after the sentence of death. *Genesis 3:20*

 - 11 Gave birth.** She bore Cain and Abel and credited the LORD with the gift of a son. *Genesis 4:1-2*

 - 12 Hoped again after grief.** After Abel's death she named Seth as God's appointed seed. *Genesis 4:25*

Across Scripture

Direct references come first. Thematic echoes are study connections, not places where the text names Eve.

Old Testament

Genesis 2:18–4:2; 4:25	The main account of her life
Genesis 5:1–2	Male and female, blessed and "called their name Adam"
Echo: Isaiah 26:17–18	Pain in childbirth as longing for rescue

New Testament

2 Corinthians 11:3	"As the serpent beguiled Eve through his subtilty"
1 Timothy 2:13–15	Eve deceived; churches differ on how it applies
Matthew 19:4–6	Jesus quotes Genesis on marriage, without naming Eve
Revelation 12:9; 20:2	The "old serpent" identified as Satan
Echo: Romans 16:20	God will crush Satan under his people's feet
Echo: Galatians 4:4	Jesus "made of a woman"

For discussion

1. *Observe:* What three things did Eve see in the tree before she ate (Genesis 3:6)?
2. *Understand:* The serpent began by questioning God's word. Why is that doubt such a powerful first step?
3. *Apply:* Eve added to God's command. Where are we tempted to make God's word harsher or softer?
4. *Apply:* Eve named Seth in hope after loss (Genesis 4:25). Where do you need to see God's faithfulness?